

L^AT_EX for Elegant Humanities Handouts in Conferences and Classrooms

Corey J. Stephan

Abstract

The world’s best established software system for typesetting and document formatting, L^AT_EX has been popular throughout the mathematical and physical sciences for decades. L^AT_EX’s utility for scholars in humanities disciplines, however, tends to be overlooked.

In this tutorial, I introduce the use of L^AT_EX for a common task in humanities scholarship, namely, typesetting texts with unusual line length and other organizational needs, such as poetry and translations. The specific example is preparing a handout for a historical conference or class presentation with perfectly organized excerpts of ancient Greek and parallel English translations.

I aim to inspire the reader to think about L^AT_EX as a flexible tool with a wider range of professional applications than it is often understood as having.

1 Introduction

This is an example article for *TUGboat*, linked from <https://tug.org/TUGboat/location.html>.

2 Basic packages and hyperlinks

The standard `graphicx` and `xcolor` packages work fine for image and color handling, respectively, as does the `hyperref` package for active urls. *TUGboat* is produced using PDF files exclusively, but conversion from DVI is fine and supported.

Please use the standard `\url` command for urls:

```
\url{https://some/url} % yes
```

For *TUGboat*, we prefer not to print the ‘`https://`’, but to include the protocol in other cases, so we usually do `\def\url{\tburl}`, which takes care of that, while keeping the source using the standard `\url` command.

In any case, please do *not* hide hyperlinks via `\href`, as in:

```
\href{https://some/url}{some text} % no!
```

When printed on paper, the url will not be visible and readers will not know it exists.

3 Abbreviation macros and typing

The `ltugboat` class provides many abbreviation commands; here are a few of the most common:

```
\AllTeX \AMS \BibTeX \Cplusplus \CTAN \DVI
\HTML \LaTeXe \macOS \MathML \MF \PDF \PS
\TUG \TUG \tug \WEB \XeLaTeX \XeTeX \XML
```

This is a column-width figure, made with `\begin{figure}`. Use `{figure*}` for a full-width (double-column) figure.

Figure 1: Caption for column-width figure.

A few other typing conventions:

- For an em-dash with our spacing (preferred to ---): `\Dash`, with output — like this.
- For initialisms in all caps: `\acro{FRED}`, with output: FRED.
- A literal control sequence: `\cs{fred}`, with output: `\fred`.
- A syntactic metavariable: `\meta{fred}`, with output: *fred*.
- A title: `\titleref{Book of Fred}`, with output: *Book of Fred*.

We recommend using `\begin{verbatim}[] ... \end{verbatim}` for code blocks, since we prefer not to colorize code when printed. But if you want to have some font changes, our recommended settings for the `listings` package are in the `ltugguid` manual mentioned below.

Please put punctuation outside quotes, “like this”, unless the punctuation is actually part of the quoted material.

Also, please put punctuation after footnotes.

4 Figures

For *TUGboat*, the standard `figure` environment produces a column-width figure; this is desirable when at all possible. The `figure*` environment produces a full-width (across both columns) figure when needed. Analogously for `table` and `table*`.

Please put captions below figures, but above tables.

Don’t worry overmuch about figure placements, as they will likely change with editing.

5 References

For references to other issues of *TUGboat*, please use the format *volno:issno*, e.g., “*TUGboat* 32:1”.

The primary *TUGboat* style documentation is the `ltugguid` manual, available online at ctan.org/pkg/tugboat or locally with `texdoc tugboat`. For general CTAN package references, we recommend that form, using `/pkg/`. If you need to refer to a specific file on CTAN, use:

```
https://mirror.ctan.org/path
```

We recommend using BIB_TE_X (but don’t require it), with the *tugboat* BIB_TE_X style. The `biblio` directory on CTAN, ctan.org/pkg/biblio, provides files `tugboat.bib` with a complete bibliography of *TUGboat*, `texbook3.bib` with many common T_EX-related books and articles, and plenty more.

Email `tugboat@tug.org` with any questions.

◇ Corey J. Stephan
2126 Berkhsire Elm Street
Katy, Texas, USA 77493
`corey.stephan@stthom.edu`
`coreystephan.com`